

LISTENING

#29

1 – Listen to two colleagues discussing a shipment problem. Pay attention to the deadline, why the current plan won't work, what solution they suggest, and what practical details they agree on (space, costs, timing, and location).

NEGOTIATING SHIPMENT DATES

1 - What did Daniel do to the existing schedule?

- a) He cleared it
- b) He delayed it
- c) He confirmed it

2 - By which date do they need the shipment to arrive?

3 - What do they say is a pity?

4 - How much space do they need?

5 - What are the two problems one woman identifies?

- a) The parts are damaged, and the factory is far away
- b) The parts must arrive by the 10th, and extra costs must be covered
- c) The docks are closed, and there is no supplier available

6 - Where does one woman think the container is right now?

- a) On the ship
- b) In the factory
- c) At the docks

7 - What solution is suggested to solve both problems?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

A Shipment Deadline

Tomas worked as a logistics coordinator for a growing electronics company. His job was to make sure that every component, tool, and spare part arrived on time. Most days were manageable, but deadlines could quickly turn an ordinary morning into a stressful one.

One Thursday, he opened his inbox and froze. A message from the production team said that an essential shipment from Taiwan hadn't left the warehouse yet. The components were supposed to arrive within ten days, and without them, the assembly line would have to stop. Even one day of delay could cost the company thousands.

Tomas immediately called their freight partner. The news wasn't good. All the scheduled containers for the week were already full, and the next available one would only leave in five days. That would be too late. He rubbed his forehead, thinking through his options. Air freight was possible, but extremely expensive — definitely not something the finance department would approve without a fight.

Then he remembered that one of their smaller suppliers sometimes shipped extra crates using shared space in containers. It wasn't guaranteed, but it was worth a try. Tomas called the supplier and explained the situation. To his relief, they said a container was leaving from Kaohsiung that evening and there *might* be enough free space.

Now, all Tomas needed to do was arrange transport to get the crates to the docks before the cut-off time. He quickly contacted the warehouse team, who promised to prepare everything within two hours. By midday, he received a message: "Shipment loaded. All good."

Tomas leaned back in his chair and let out a long breath. It wasn't perfect planning, but it was a quick solution. He knew he had gotten lucky this time — and that he needed to tighten their scheduling process. Still, avoiding a shutdown felt like a major win.

Comprehension Questions

1 - What problem does Tomas discover in the morning?

2 - Why isn't the next available container a good option?

3 - What alternative shipping option does Tomas consider?

4 - Do you often deal with deadlines in your daily life? How do you manage them?

5 - How do you usually react when an unexpected problem appears?
